

PikaCart

Full Build Specification

A solo-owner digital products store + WhatsApp-negotiated custom website service business, built on the existing DigiMarket WordPress theme in Single Seller Mode.

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Version 1.1 · September 2026 — adds SEO-in-code, coupons, hosting affiliate, professional service-page features

Status: Ready to build from — every open decision from prior discussion is resolved below.

How to use this document

This is a complete blueprint, not a to-do list. It fixes every field, page, price band and workflow so nothing is decided ad hoc while building. Read it once end to end, mark anything you want changed, then hand it back — the build follows this document exactly.

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1 Executive Summary & Business Model

PikaCart is a single-owner online store at pikacart.in combining two revenue lines under one brand, one login system and one design:

- Digital Products — instantly downloadable files (study notes, resume templates, business templates, design assets, WordPress themes, kids' learning material). Buyer pays online, gets the file immediately.
- Services — custom website development (schools, colleges, committees, shops, cafés, restaurants) shown as a priced catalogue but sold through a WhatsApp conversation, not online checkout. Payment and delivery are agreed off-platform.

This is deliberately not a multi-vendor marketplace. Only the site owner lists items. That single decision removes the GST/TCS/e-commerce-operator obligations that apply to marketplaces, removes the need for Razorpay Route (seller payout splitting), and removes an entire seller-onboarding/KYC subsystem from day one. It can be turned back on later (the underlying software already supports it) if the business ever expands to other sellers.

Why this combination works

- Digital products are passive: built once, sold many times, no back-and-forth.
- Services are high-value but low-volume: a handful of website projects a month at a much higher ticket size funds the business while the digital-product catalogue grows.
- Each pulls the other: a visitor who came for a ₹49 resume template discovers the ₹5,000 website service, and a committee that ordered a website discovers the ₹99 accounts-tracker template.

What changed from the original multi-vendor plan

Area	Original plan (Section spec.pdf)	Final decision (this document)
Sellers	Unlimited third-party sellers, KYC, payouts	Single seller — the site owner only
Commission engine	Global/category/per-seller % + launch promo	Not applicable — all revenue is the owner's
Payment split	Razorpay Route, linked accounts per seller	Not needed. Standard Razorpay account only

Area	Original plan (Section spec.pdf)	Final decision (this document)
GST	Mandatory as an e-commerce operator, any turnover	Normal seller rules — ₹20L threshold applies (confirm with a CA before scaling)
Website-building work	Not in original spec	New: a Services catalogue, WhatsApp-quoted, no online payment
Dashboard sections	Fixed set of categories	Fully admin-editable — see Section 5

2 Market Research Findings

What already exists, and where PikaCart fits

2.1 Solo-seller digital storefronts

Freelancer-facing platforms (Gumroad-style link-in-bio stores, Payhip, SureCart on WordPress) validate the core mechanic: a single creator selling templates and service packages side by side from one page, keeping ownership of the storefront rather than paying a marketplace's cut. The common pattern is a short, visual homepage (portfolio + shop in one), transparent starting prices, and a direct contact channel for anything custom — exactly the split PikaCart is built around.

2.2 Puja/committee financial transparency — a validated, underserved niche

A dedicated open-source tool (GPMS — Ganesh Puja Management System) already exists to digitise a puja committee's donations and expenses, and its standout feature is telling: every donation receipt is QR-coded and shared instantly over WhatsApp, and is publicly verifiable so no one can dispute it later. Separately, established Indian trust/NGO software (Sanstha ERP, TrustSetu) report that digitising donation and expense records measurably cuts accounting disputes and errors for temples and trusts.

Takeaway for PikaCart: build the “Chanda-Kharch Tracker” (Section 6) with a WhatsApp-shareable, QR-coded receipt for every donation entry from day one — it is the single most requested trust feature in this niche, and no low-cost, India-specific competitor currently owns it.

2.3 SEO for a small, single-owner catalogue

Current best practice (2026) for product-style pages is unambiguous and directly shapes Section 10 of this document:

- Every page needs a unique meta title and meta description — duplicating one page's tags on another actively hurts ranking.
- Meta titles: 50–60 characters, primary keyword near the front.
- Meta descriptions: 120–160 characters, one clear benefit + a call to action (they don't affect ranking directly, but they drive the click).
- Structured data (schema.org Product / Service / LocalBusiness markup) is treated as close to mandatory now — it is what lets Google show price, rating and availability directly in search results, and what AI answer engines read to describe a listing.

- Write original description copy per listing; never reuse manufacturer/template boilerplate across items.

2.4 Conclusion

The plan is sound. The two additions this research motivates are: (1) a WhatsApp-shareable QR donation receipt inside the committee tracker product, and (2) treating the SEO fields in Section 10 as mandatory-to-publish, not optional extras, since they are the main free acquisition channel for a one-person business with no ad budget.

3 Who Buys From PikaCart

Persona	What they come for	What convinces them to buy
Student (school/college/competitive exam)	Notes, previous-year papers, project report templates	Free preview page, verified reviews, instant download
Job seeker / fresher	Resume templates, cover letters	Before/after look, ATS-friendly claim, ₹49-199 price point
Small business owner (shop/café/restaurant)	A simple, professional website	Clear starting price, example sites shown, fast WhatsApp reply
School/college admin	An informational website with admissions info, notices	Trust signals (other schools done), AMC/support offered
Puja/festival committee member	A donation-transparent website or the accounts-tracker sheet	Explicit “no one can dispute the numbers” framing, QR receipts
Freelancer/creator	Canva templates, invoice templates, business templates	Bundle pricing, instant download, preview thumbnails
Parent (Kids section)	Worksheets, activity sheets, simple learning templates	Age-band labelling, safe/simple checkout, low price

4 Site Structure — the Two Pillars

4.1 Global navigation

Header: Logo · Categories dropdown · Search · Cart · Account. Footer: About, Categories, Services, Legal, WhatsApp chat button (shown site-wide, not just on service pages).

4.2 Homepage sections, top to bottom

- 1 Hero — headline + subheadline (Section 14 gives exact copy) + search bar.
- 2 Trust strip — secure payment, instant delivery, WhatsApp support, refund policy — four short icons+lines.
- 3 Shop by category — tiles for every top-level category (Section 8), auto-updates as categories are added (Section 5).
- 4 Trending digital products — best-selling instant-download items.

- 5 Website & service packages — a distinct visual band (different background tint) showing 3–6 service cards with “Starting from ₹X” and a WhatsApp button, so it reads as a different kind of offer from the product grid above it.
- 6 New arrivals.
- 7 Footer CTA — “Need something custom? Chat on WhatsApp.”

4.3 Two listing types, one catalogue

Both Digital Products and Services live in the same product catalogue and share categories/tags/search, but render differently on their own page (Sections 6 and 7) and are visually distinguished everywhere they appear together (a small “Service” tag/badge on the card).

5 Dynamic Sections & Categories

“I want to add whatever section I like, whenever I like” — this section is the answer

This was an explicit requirement: the dashboard must never need a developer to add a new line of business. Everything below is achievable by the site owner alone, in the admin dashboard, in under two minutes each:

5.1 Adding a new category

- 1 Admin → Categories → Add New.
- 2 Type a name (e.g. “Wedding Invitations”), optionally a short description and an icon/emoji.
- 3 Save. It instantly appears in the header dropdown, the homepage “Shop by category” grid, the footer, and the product filter sidebar — no other step.

5.2 Adding a new product or service

Exactly the existing Add Product screen (Section 6/7 lists every field). No category is hard-coded into the software: a product simply gets assigned to whichever categories exist at the time.

5.3 Featuring / reordering what the homepage shows

- Any product can be flagged “Featured” to appear in the homepage hero rotator.
- Any product can be flagged “Service” (Section 7) to render as a WhatsApp-enquiry card instead of a Buy button.
- Homepage section toggles (Trending / New Arrivals / Trust strip) can each be turned on or off from Settings without touching a template.

5.4 What this deliberately does NOT require

- No new database table, no new template file, no developer request for a normal new category or product.
- A genuinely new type of listing (e.g. something that needs its own custom checkout flow entirely unlike “buy instantly” or “WhatsApp enquiry”) is the one case that still needs a small development change — call this out explicitly when it comes up, don't assume it fits the two existing types.

6

Digital Products — Field-by-Field Specification

Every digital product listing captures the following. Fields marked (required to publish) block publishing until filled; others can be saved as draft.

Field	Required?	Notes
Title	Required	Max 70 characters recommended for SEO (see Section 10).
URL slug	Auto-generated	Editable; must stay unique.
Short description	Required	1-2 lines, shown on cards and search results snippet fallback.
Full description	Required	Rich text. What it is, who it's for, what's inside.
"What you get" checklist	Required	New field — a bullet list rendered prominently on the product page, e.g. "PDF, 42 pages · Editable Word file · Lifetime updates." This is the explicit "what we delivered" requirement — it tells the buyer exactly what lands in their inbox before they pay.
Category (one or more)	Required	From the ever-growing list in Section 5.
Tags	Optional	Free-text, comma separated, powers related-items and search.
Price / Sale price	Required	See Section 9 for bands.
Thumbnail image	Required	1:1 or 4:3, min 800×800px.
Gallery (up to 5 images)	Optional but recommended	Screenshots/preview pages sell templates and notes better than any copy.
Delivery type	Required	File download / License key / External link — unchanged from existing system.
Digital file / license keys / link	Required (matching delivery type)	
Download limit / access days	Optional	0 = unlimited / lifetime.
SEO meta title	Required to publish	Section 10 gives the exact formula.
SEO meta description	Required to publish	Section 10 gives the exact formula.
Age band (Kids section only)	Required for Kids category	e.g. "4-6 yrs", "7-9 yrs" — shown as a badge on the card.

Product page layout (buyer-facing)

- 1 Image gallery.
- 2 Title, category, rating & sales count.
- 3 Price box: price, "What you get" checklist, Buy Now / Add to Cart, secure-checkout line.

- 4 Full description.
- 5 Reviews (verified buyers only, unchanged from existing system).
- 6 Related products from the same categories.

7 Services (WhatsApp) — Field-by-Field Specification

A Service uses the same product editor with one toggle switched on: “This is a service (no online payment)”. Turning it on changes both the required fields and the buyer-facing page.

Field	Required?	Notes
Title	Required	e.g. “School & College Website Development”. Include the main search phrase (Section 10.6).
Target city / area served	Optional	e.g. “Odisha · All India (remote)”. Feeds Service structured data and the H1 on local landing pages.
Short & full description	Required	What the service includes at a glance, then in detail.
“What's included” checklist	Required	e.g. “Up to 6 pages · Admissions form · Mobile-friendly · 1 free revision round · 3 months free support.”
Starting price	Required	Shown as “Starting from ₹X” — informational, not a checkout price (Section 9).
Turnaround time	Required	e.g. “5–7 working days after we confirm requirements.” Sets expectations before the WhatsApp chat even starts.
Category	Required	“Website Services” as parent, sub-category per audience (School, Committee, Shop/Café, etc.).
Thumbnail + gallery	Required	Screenshots of 2–3 real or example sites in that category — the single biggest trust builder per the research in Section 2.
Service WhatsApp number	Optional	Falls back to the site-wide default number in Settings if left blank — lets you route different service lines to different numbers later if needed.
Pre-filled WhatsApp message	Optional	Falls back to an auto-generated “Hi, I'm interested in [service name]” message.
SEO meta title / description	Required to publish	Section 10.

Service page layout (buyer-facing) — differs from a Digital Product

- 1 Image gallery (portfolio screenshots).
- 2 Title, category.
- 3 Price box: “Starting from ₹X”, turnaround time, “What's included” checklist, single button — “Enquire on WhatsApp” (no Buy Now, no Add to Cart, no cart icon interaction at all).
- 4 Full description.
- 5 Packages table (Basic / Standard / Premium) — Section 7.4.
- 6 How it works — 4-step process strip.
- 7 Portfolio / live demos for this service type.

- 8 Reviews & ratings — shown under every service, exactly like digital products (Section 7.5 explains how service clients are verified).
- 9 FAQ block (5-8 questions) + enquiry form + final WhatsApp CTA.

The WhatsApp-to-delivery flow, end to end

- 1 Visitor reads the service page, clicks Enquire on WhatsApp — opens a chat with a pre-filled message naming the service.
- 2 Owner discusses requirements, agrees a final price and timeline in chat.
- 3 Owner collects payment directly (UPI/bank transfer) — outside PikaCart's checkout, by design (Section 1 explains why).
- 4 Owner builds and delivers the site; hands over access/credentials over WhatsApp or email.
- 5 If a requirement genuinely can't be delivered, the owner refunds the amount collected directly (this is a manual promise made in the service's refund copy, not a platform-enforced refund, since payment never went through PikaCart for services).

Because this is a manual, chat-based promise rather than a payment-gateway refund, the service description must say explicitly: “If we cannot deliver what was agreed, you get a full refund of any amount already paid.” Put this sentence on every service page and in the WhatsApp opening message template.

7.4 Professional service-page features (new)

Feature	What it does	Admin controls
Portfolio / Live demo	New listing type “Portfolio item”: screenshots (desktop + mobile), live demo URL (opens in new tab), which service category it belongs to, client type (school/committee/café), short case study (problem → what we built → result). Shown as a grid on /portfolio/ and filtered automatically on each matching service page.	Add / edit / reorder portfolio items; mark as “demo” (sample site) or “client work” so claims stay honest.
Packages table	Basic / Standard / Premium columns per service, each with its own “Starting from ₹X”, feature ticks/crosses and its own WhatsApp button whose pre-filled message names the package (e.g. “Hi, I want the Standard School Website package”). One column can be flagged “Most popular”.	Up to 3 packages per service; rows of features editable as a simple list.
How it works strip	4 steps: Chat on WhatsApp → Design approval → Build & review → Launch + support. Removes the fear of the unknown for first-time website buyers.	Global default text, overridable per service.
Testimonials	Quote, client name, organisation, city, optional photo/logo, star rating. Shown on homepage, service pages and /portfolio/.	Admin adds/approves; only real clients (see 7.5).
FAQ per service	5-8 Q&As; rendered as an accordion (“How long does it take?”, “Do I need to buy hosting?”, “Can I update it myself?”, “What if I don't like the design?”). Also emitted as FAQPage structured data (Section 10).	Repeater field on every service; site-wide default FAQs as fallback.
Enquiry form	Backup for people who don't want to WhatsApp: name, phone, email, website type (dropdown), budget range, message. Saved to an admin “Leads” list, emailed to the owner, and the thank-you screen offers “Continue on WhatsApp” with the details pre-filled. Honeypot + rate-limit anti-spam, no captcha friction.	Leads list with status: New / Contacted / Quoted / Won / Lost + notes; CSV export.

Feature	What it does	Admin controls
Trust bar	Projects delivered count, average rating, response time ("Usually replies within 1 hour"), refund promise badge.	Numbers editable in Settings; rating computed from real reviews.

7.5 Reviews under every service (and every product)

Requirement: every listing — digital product, WordPress template and website service — shows reviews and a star rating under it. Digital products already allow reviews from verified buyers only. Services are paid off-site, so they need their own verification path to keep reviews genuine:

- 1 After delivering a project, the owner opens Admin → Services → "Request review", enters the client's name + phone/email and picks the service.
- 2 PikaCart generates a one-time, expiring review link (valid 30 days, single use) and a ready-to-send WhatsApp message containing it.
- 3 Client opens the link — no account needed — gives 1–5 stars, a title, text, and optionally a photo of their live site. The review is tagged "Verified client".
- 4 Owner can reply publicly under the review; can hide abusive content but cannot edit the client's words or star rating (keeps trust honest).
- 5 Average rating + review count appear on the service card, the service page header, and in structured data (Section 10).

Review display rules for all listings: newest + most helpful sort, star-breakdown bar (5★ ... 1★), "Verified buyer" / "Verified client" badge, owner reply, pagination after 10, and a "Write a review" button shown only to people eligible to review. Ask for a review automatically: digital buyers get an email 3 days after purchase; service clients get the WhatsApp review link at hand-over.

8 Category Plan at Launch

8.1 Digital Products

Category	Starter items to list	Typical price
Study Notes	Board/college notes, previous-year question papers, project report templates	₹29 – ₹199
Resume & Career	Resume templates, cover letter templates, LinkedIn banner templates	₹49 – ₹149
Business & Committee Tools	Invoice template, quotation template, Chanda-Kharch (donation/expense) Tracker with WhatsApp-shareable QR receipts	₹99 – ₹499
Design Templates	Canva social media packs, poster/banner templates, logo templates	₹49 – ₹299
WordPress & Tech Templates	Ready-made website templates (buyer self-installs) — School, Committee, Café/Restaurant themes	₹999 – ₹2,999
Kids Zone	Worksheets, activity sheets, simple flashcard sets, colouring templates, age-banded	₹29 – ₹99

8.2 Services

Sub-category	Starting price shown	What's typically included
School / College Website	Starting ₹5,000	Up to 6 pages, admissions enquiry form, notices section, mobile-friendly
Puja / Committee Website	Starting ₹3,000	Donation & expense tracker page, event gallery, committee members page
Shop / Café / Restaurant Website	Starting ₹4,000	Menu/catalogue page, location & hours, WhatsApp order button
Business / Portfolio Website	Starting ₹3,500	About, services, contact, portfolio gallery
Website Maintenance (AMC)	Starting ₹999 / year	Uptime checks, content updates, minor fixes

These are starting anchors to display, not fixed contracts — the real price is agreed on WhatsApp per Section 7. Revisit every quarter against actual quotes given.

9 Pricing Strategy & Price Bands

9.1 Digital products — three-tier ladder

Tier	Price band	Use for
Entry	₹29 – ₹99	Single-page templates, worksheets, small note sets — low-friction impulse buys that build trust and reviews fast.
Core	₹149 – ₹499	Full note sets, multi-template packs, the accounts tracker — the main revenue tier.
Premium	₹999+	Ready-made website templates, large bundles — fewer buyers, higher margin.

9.2 Discount pricing

- Use the existing “sale price” field to show a struck-through original price — the theme already renders this with a percentage-off badge.
- Reserve real discounts (20–40%) for a launch week and festival periods (Diwali, New Year, exam season for notes) rather than running them constantly, or the strike-through loses credibility.

9.3 Services — pricing logic to use in WhatsApp negotiation

Base every quote on three inputs, stated out loud to the client so pricing feels reasoned, not arbitrary:

- 1 Base package price (the “Starting from” shown on-site) for the standard scope.
- 2 + per extra page/feature beyond the standard scope (e.g. +₹500 per extra page, +₹1,000 for a payment/donation gateway integration).
- 3 + rush fee if turnaround is compressed below the stated standard (e.g. +25% for under-3-day delivery).

9.4 Annual review

Revisit every price band once a quarter against: (a) actual conversion data from the site, (b) what similar solo sellers charge on Instagram/Etsy-equivalent channels for the same categories, (c) whether the entry tier is still driving enough reviews to justify its low margin.

10 SEO Built Into the Code

Every rule below is enforced by the theme itself, so each page ships search-ready

Goal: roughly 80% of the work that decides ranking — speed, structure, tags, schema, indexing, internal links — is done automatically by the code, on every page, forever. The owner only supplies good words and real reviews; the theme does everything else and refuses to publish a listing that would hurt the site.

Honest expectation: code makes a page eligible to rank and lets Google understand it perfectly. Reaching the top for competitive phrases additionally needs time (typically 3–6 months for a new domain), unique useful content, genuine reviews and a few quality backlinks (Section 10.13). No developer can guarantee position #1 — anyone who does is guessing.

10.1 Speed & Core Web Vitals (a ranking signal, and the #1 cause of lost mobile buyers)

Metric (mobile, field data)	Target	How the code achieves it
LCP — main content visible	< 2.5 s	Server-rendered PHP (no JS needed to show content); hero/product image gets fetchpriority="high" and is never lazy-loaded; critical CSS inlined in <head>, rest loaded non-blocking.
INP — tap responsiveness	< 200 ms	Vanilla JS only (no jQuery on the front end), all scripts defer, no heavy sliders; total JS < 50 KB.
CLS — layout stability	< 0.1	Every outputs width/height; fixed-ratio card thumbnails; fonts use font-display: swap with size-adjusted fallback.
Page weight (homepage, mobile)	< 500 KB first load	Uploads auto-converted to WebP, responsive srcset/sizes, below-the-fold images loading="lazy", self-hosted Poppins subset (latin, 2 weights) preloaded.
Lighthouse (mobile)	Performance ≥ 90, SEO = 100, Accessibility ≥ 95, Best Practices ≥ 95	Checked on homepage, a category, a product, a service and an article as a build acceptance test.

Server side: output compatible with LiteSpeed Cache (MilesWeb) — public pages cacheable, cart/checkout/account excluded; long-lived cache headers on versioned assets; gzip/brotli; no render-blocking third-party scripts (Razorpay's script loads only on checkout).

10.2 Head tags generated automatically on every page

Tag	Rule enforced by the theme
<title>	From the SEO title field; fallback formula “{Name} – {Category} PikaCart”; trimmed to 60 chars; site name never duplicated.
meta description	From the SEO description field; fallback = short description trimmed at a word boundary to 155 chars. Never empty, never the same on two pages.
canonical	Self-referencing absolute HTTPS URL on every indexable page. Sort/filter/UTM/?ref parameters canonicalise to the clean URL.
robots meta	index,follow,max-image-preview:large,max-snippet:-1 on public pages; noindex,follow on cart, checkout, account, dashboard, login/register, download, invoice, internal search results, empty categories, thin tag pages.
Open Graph + Twitter card	og:title, og:description, og:image (1200×630 auto-cropped from the thumbnail with the PikaCart badge), og:type product/article/website, product:price:amount + currency INR. Makes every WhatsApp/Facebook share look professional — important because WhatsApp is the main sharing channel.
lang / viewport / theme-color	<html lang="en-IN">; mobile viewport; indigo theme-color; favicon + apple-touch-icon + web manifest from the logo pack.
Verification	Settings fields for Google Search Console and Bing verification codes (output as meta tags), so no plugin is needed.

10.3 Structured data (JSON-LD) — what lets Google show price, stars and breadcrumbs

Page	Schema output automatically
Every page	Organization (name, logo, url, WhatsApp contact point, sameAs social links from Settings) + WebSite.
Digital product	Product with name, description, image[], sku (product ID), brand PikaCart, offers {price, priceCurrency INR, availability InStock, url, priceValidUntil for sale prices}, aggregateRating + review[] only when real reviews exist; BreadcrumbList.
Service	Service with serviceType, provider (Organization), areaServed, offers with priceSpecification (minPrice = starting price, INR), plus hasOfferCatalog listing the Basic/Standard/Premium packages; FAQPage from the service FAQ; BreadcrumbList. Service reviews are shown on the page; Google may not show stars for self-owned business reviews, which is expected and fine.
Category / section page	CollectionPage + ItemList of the products on that page + BreadcrumbList.
Portfolio item	CreativeWork with screenshot, url (live demo), about (client type).
Article	BlogPosting with headline, author (real person, About page link), datePublished/dateModified, image.
About / Contact	ProfessionalService (area served, WhatsApp/phone, email, opening hours) — used for local search once the Google Business Profile exists.

Rule: schema must match what is visible on the page (no hidden prices, no invented ratings). Build acceptance: every page type passes Google's Rich Results Test and the Schema.org validator with zero errors.

10.4 Clean HTML structure

- Exactly one H1 per page = the product/service/category name (with the main keyword); H2/H3 in logical order, never skipped for styling.
- Semantic landmarks: header, nav, main, article, aside, footer; breadcrumbs visible on every product, service, category and article page (Home > Services > School Website).
- All real content is in the HTML the server sends — tabs/accordions (description, FAQ, reviews) are collapsed with CSS/details elements, not loaded later by JavaScript, so Google reads everything.
- Links are real <a href> elements with descriptive anchor text (“School website packages”, never “click here”); buttons that navigate are links, not JS click handlers.
- Every image has meaningful alt text (required field); decorative icons use empty alt.

10.5 URL architecture & redirects

Content	URL pattern	Example
Digital product	/product/{keyword-slug}/	/product/cbse-class-10-physics-notes-pdf/
Service	/services/{keyword-slug}/	/services/school-website-development/
Category / section	/category/{slug}/	/category/resume-templates/
Portfolio	/portfolio/{slug}/	/portfolio/durga-puja-committee-bhubaneswar/
Local landing page	/services/{service}/{city}/	/services/school-website-development/bhubaneswar/
Article	/articles/{slug}/	/articles/puja-committee-donation-tracking/

- Slugs: lowercase, hyphens, keyword first, no stop-words, no dates, max ~60 chars; auto-suggested from the title, editable.
- Changing a slug automatically stores a 301 redirect from the old URL. Deleted/unpublished products 301 to their category instead of returning a 404.
- One host only: https://pikacart.in (http and www 301 to it); consistent trailing slash.
- Author archives, date archives and attachment pages are disabled/redirected (single seller — they would only create duplicate thin pages).
- Custom 404 page with search, top categories and WhatsApp button; every 404 hit is logged in admin with a one-click “create redirect”.

10.6 Keyword targeting built into each page template

Each page type is designed around one clear search intent. Target phrases (validate with Google Search Console + Google autocomplete after launch; Hinglish variants included because the audience searches that way):

Page	Primary intent / example phrases
School website service	school website development, school website design price in India, college website banane ka kharcha, school website with admission form
Puja/committee website	puja committee website, durga puja committee website, ganesh puja donation website, chanda hisab website
Shop/café/restaurant website	restaurant website design, cafe website with menu, small business website price, dukan ki website kaise banaye
Committee tracker (product)	puja chanda kharch excel sheet, committee donation register format, donation receipt with QR
Study notes	{board} class {n} {subject} notes pdf, previous year question paper {exam}

Page	Primary intent / example phrases
Resume templates	resume format for freshers, ATS resume template download, resume template word free/₹49
Kids worksheets	class 1 maths worksheets pdf, kids activity sheets printable, colouring pages for kids pdf
Hosting (affiliate)	best hosting for school website, cheap wordpress hosting india

Local landing pages (/services/{service}/{city}/) are generated only when the owner writes a genuinely unique intro, a local portfolio example or testimonial, and city-specific FAQ — the editor blocks publishing near-duplicate city pages (Google treats mass-produced city pages as doorway spam).

10.7 The SEO panel in the product/service editor

Every add/edit screen gets an “SEO” panel that works like a built-in Yoast/RankMath, with no plugin:

- Live Google preview (mobile snippet) updating as you type.
- Focus keyword field with green/amber/red checks: keyword in title, in H1, in slug, in first 100 words, in at least one image alt, in meta description.
- Character counters with colour bands: title 50–60, description 120–160.
- Duplicate detector: warns if the title, description or focus keyword is already used by another listing (prevents pages competing with each other).
- Content length guide: digital products ≥ 150 words, services ≥ 500 words, local pages ≥ 600 words, articles ≥ 900 words.
- Internal-link suggestions: “Link to: Puja Committee Website service” when writing the committee tracker product, and vice-versa.
- Social preview (how it will look when shared on WhatsApp).
- Publish gate: cannot publish without SEO title, SEO description, focus keyword, at least one image with alt text, a category, and — for services — FAQ (min 3) and What's-included list.

10.8 Category / section pages (often the pages that rank best)

- Each category gets its own SEO title, description, H1, intro text (100–200 words above the grid) and FAQ (below the grid) — editable, and required before the category shows in navigation.
- Pagination: page 2+ self-canonical, titles suffixed “– Page 2”; filtered/sorted views noindex with canonical to the base category.
- Empty categories are hidden and noindexed automatically until they have products.

10.9 Internal linking system (automatic)

- Breadcrumbs everywhere; header mega-menu and footer link to every top-level category and every service.
- “Related” blocks: same category + shared tags; every service links to its portfolio items and matching templates; every committee/school product links to the matching website service (cross-sell = internal links).
- Articles: “Products mentioned” block auto-links listings referenced in the text.
- Admin “Orphan pages” report: any published listing with zero internal links pointing to it is flagged.

10.10 Images

- On upload: renamed from the title (cbse-class-10-physics-notes-cover.webp), converted to WebP, resized to 5 sizes, EXIF stripped.

- Alt text required; auto-suggested from the product name, editable.
- Images listed in the XML sitemap; product images at least 1200 px wide on the long side (needed for large image previews in Google).

10.11 Crawling & indexing

- XML sitemap index at /wp-sitemap.xml (WordPress core, extended): products, services, categories, portfolio, articles, pages — with lastmod; excludes every noindex page.
- robots.txt generated by the theme: Disallow /cart/, /checkout/, /account/, /dashboard/, /download/, /go/, /?s=, /wp-admin/ (Allow admin-ajax); includes the Sitemap line.
- IndexNow ping to Bing/Yandex on publish/update (Google discovers via sitemap + Search Console).
- No duplicate content: print/preview views noindex; tag pages noindex unless they have ≥ 5 products and an intro.

10.12 Trust signals Google looks for (E-E-A-T)

- About page with the real owner name, photo, skills, projects count; linked from every service page and as the author of articles.
- Contact page with WhatsApp, email and area served; Terms, Privacy, Refund, Delivery/Service policy linked in the footer of every page.
- Real reviews under every listing (Section 7.5), portfolio with live demos, HTTPS everywhere, secure payment badges near checkout.

10.13 The remaining 20% — owner's job after launch (code cannot do this)

- 1 Verify Google Search Console + Bing Webmaster, submit sitemap on day 1.
- 2 Create a Google Business Profile as a service-area business (website designer) — the fastest way to appear in local “near me” searches.
- 3 Write 1-2 helpful articles a month on the phrases in 10.6; answer the questions buyers ask on WhatsApp as posts.
- 4 Collect reviews after every sale/project (the system automates the request).
- 5 Earn a few genuine backlinks: listings in local business directories, school/committee clients linking “Website by PikaCart” in their footer (add this credit to every delivered site), guest posts, Quora/Reddit answers.
- 6 Monthly: check Search Console for pages with impressions but low clicks — improve their titles/descriptions first.

10.14 SEO acceptance tests before the build is signed off

Test	Pass condition
Lighthouse mobile on 5 page types	Perf ≥ 90, SEO 100, A11y ≥ 95
Rich Results Test	Product, Service, FAQ, Breadcrumb, Organization valid, 0 errors
Crawl the site (Screaming Frog free / script)	0 broken links, 0 duplicate titles/descriptions, every indexable page has canonical + 1 H1
noindex check	Cart, checkout, account, dashboard, search, download all noindex; none of them in sitemap
Redirect check	http→https, www→non-www, changed slug→301, deleted product→category 301

Test	Pass condition
Share preview	WhatsApp link preview shows image, title, price for a product and a service

11 Buyer Journey & Buyer Dashboard

11.1 Digital product purchase flow (unchanged, already built and tested)

- 1 Browse/search → product page → Add to Cart or Buy Now.
- 2 Checkout → Razorpay payment (UPI/card/netbanking).
- 3 Instant confirmation page with download button; confirmation email sent.
- 4 Item always available again from My Account → My Purchases.

11.2 Service enquiry flow

- 1 Browse service page → “Enquire on WhatsApp” → chat opens with pre-filled context.
- 2 No account, login or payment required to enquire — keep this frictionless since it's a lead-generation step, not a transaction.

11.3 Buyer dashboard (“My Account”) — unchanged from existing build

- My Purchases (instant re-download), Order History with downloadable invoices, Wishlist, Profile, Support ticket for any order issue.

12 Admin Dashboard Requirements

12.1 Already built (verify still fits Single Seller Mode)

- Overview: revenue, orders, top products, sales trend chart.
- Products: full CRUD as specified in Sections 6–7, bulk publish/unpublish/duplicate/delete.
- Orders: full order list with filters, CSV export, refund action.
- Reviews, Coupons, Support tickets, Audit log — unchanged.
- Settings → Single Seller Mode toggle, default WhatsApp number (already shipped).

12.2 New for this plan

Requirement	Why
“What you get” / “What's included” checklist field on every listing	Explicit deliverable requirement from this brief — Sections 6–7.
Per-category icon/emoji field	So homepage category tiles look designed, not default, as new sections are added — Section 5.

Requirement	Why
Simple analytics: which categories/services get the most WhatsApp clicks vs. page views	Tells the owner where to add more listings next, without needing Google Analytics literacy.
Leads list (enquiry form) + “Request review” for service clients	Sections 7.4–7.5.
Portfolio items, testimonials, packages, FAQ editors	Section 7.4.
SEO panel + publish gate, redirects manager, 404 log, orphan-page report	Section 10.
Coupon additions + Partner offers with /go/ click reports	Sections 17–18.

13 Payments, Refunds & Money Flow

13.1 Digital products

Unchanged: Razorpay Checkout, standard account (no Route/linked accounts needed in Single Seller Mode — already implemented and tested). Refunds are issued from the admin order screen and automatically revoke file access.

13.2 Services

No online payment on PikaCart at all. Money moves owner ↔ client directly (UPI/bank transfer), negotiated on WhatsApp per Section 7. The refund promise is a written policy commitment, honoured manually.

13.3 What stays true either way

- Never store card details — Razorpay Checkout handles this entirely; PikaCart never sees or stores card numbers.
- Every digital-product transaction is logged in the admin ledger with a CSV export for accounting/GST purposes.

14 Branding, Design & Content Voice

14.1 Already delivered

- Logo pack (SVG/PNG/favicon), colour palette (Indigo #5B4BFF primary, Violet/Yellow accents), Poppins typography — already produced and in the repo.

14.2 Homepage copy (final, ready to paste in)

Headline: “India Ka Digital Products Marketplace”

Subheadline: “Ebooks, courses, templates, software aur bahut kuch. UPI se pay karo, turant download.”

(Swap in a services-forward variant seasonally, e.g. during a school-admissions season: “Websites Built for Schools, Shops & Committees — Notes & Templates for Everyone Else.”)

14.3 Voice

- Digital products copy: short, benefit-first, in Hinglish where natural (matches the audience research in Section 3).
- Service copy: confident and specific about turnaround/inclusions (Section 7) — vague service pages are the single biggest trust-killer for a solo freelancer site.

15 Legal, Tax & Compliance Summary

This section is a plain-language summary for planning purposes only — confirm every figure with a CA before launch, as rules and thresholds change.

- Single seller → normal GST rules. Because PikaCart is not a marketplace with third-party sellers, the mandatory-registration-regardless-of-turnover rule for e-commerce operators does not apply. The standard threshold for services (commonly cited around ₹20 lakh/year) applies instead — confirm the current figure with a CA.
- Government-employee side-business rule. If the owner is a government employee, most conduct rules require written permission before running any private trade/business — independent of GST. Resolve this before the business takes real payments (a family member's name is a common workaround, discussed and left as an open decision for the owner).
- Standard legal pages (already generated by the theme): Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, Refund Policy. Still to write: a Contact Us page and a plain-language Delivery/Service Policy page explicitly covering the WhatsApp service flow's refund promise (Section 7).
- Keep the CSV export of all transactions (already built) as the source data for whichever tax filing route is chosen.

16 Analytics & Growth Plan

First 90 days

- 1 Week 1–2: finish Contact Us + Delivery Policy pages, submit sitemap to Google Search Console, connect WhatsApp Business number.
- 2 Week 3–4: publish the full Section 8 starter catalogue (aim: 15–20 digital products, 4–6 service listings live).
- 3 Month 2: first article, start asking every buyer for a review, share service portfolio screenshots on Instagram/WhatsApp status.
- 4 Month 3: review Section 9 pricing against real conversion data; add the next category based on what buyers actually search for on-site (built-in search logs which terms return zero results — that's the next product to make).

17 Coupons & Promotions

17.1 Already built and working

- Admin → PikaCart → Coupons & promotions: code, % or flat ₹ discount, minimum order, valid from/until dates, total usage limit, active on/off, times-used counter.
- Buyer applies the code in the cart; clear errors for invalid, expired, not-yet-active, limit reached, below minimum. Razorpay is charged the discounted amount; the discount is stored on the order and invoice.
- Applies to digital products only — services are priced and discounted in the WhatsApp conversation.

17.2 Additions

Feature	Detail
Category / product scope	Limit a coupon to chosen categories or products (e.g. NOTES20 only on Study Notes).
First order only	Valid only for a buyer's first paid order (welcome offer).
Per-customer limit	e.g. once per account/email, separate from the total usage limit.
Maximum discount cap	For % coupons: “20% off up to ₹100”.
Shareable apply link	pikacart.in/?coupon=DIWALI30 stores the code and auto-applies it in the cart — for WhatsApp status, Instagram and email campaigns. Link canonicalises to the clean URL (no SEO duplication).
Announcement bar	Optional site-wide top bar: “Use PIKA10 for 10% off” with countdown to valid-until; on/off in Settings.
Product-page hint	“Best offer: ₹X with code NOTES20” under the price when an eligible public coupon exists; private coupons never shown.
Report	Per-coupon orders, revenue and discount given; CSV export.

18 Hosting & Tools Affiliate System

Earn commission by recommending hosting, domains and tools — no payment on PikaCart

Website clients always need hosting and a domain. Instead of only telling them where to buy it, PikaCart recommends partner offers through the owner's affiliate links (e.g. hosting companies' official affiliate programmes) and earns the partner's referral commission. The buyer pays the partner directly; PikaCart never handles that payment.

18.1 New listing type: “Partner offer”

Field	Notes
Partner name, logo, title	e.g. “Hostinger Premium Web Hosting — best for school websites”.
Affiliate URL	The tracking link from the partner's affiliate dashboard (stored privately, never printed in page HTML).
Cloaked link slug	Public link becomes pikacart.in/go/hostinger — 302 redirect to the affiliate URL. Changing partner = change one field, every link on the site updates.
Price shown	“From ₹X/month” + optional partner coupon code the visitor can copy.
Button text	Default “Get this deal →”; opens in a new tab.
Pros / cons, “Best for”	Short honest comparison — the content that makes affiliate pages rank and convert.
Category	Placed in a “Hosting & Domains” / “Tools we use” section (Section 5 dynamic categories).
SEO fields	Same mandatory SEO panel as every listing (Section 10.7).

18.2 Behaviour & placement

- Card and page show a “Partner” badge; no Buy/Cart buttons — only the outbound deal button.
- Cross-sell on every website service page: a “Recommended hosting for this website” box with 1–3 partner offers — the natural moment clients need it.
- Comparison page /hosting/ — table of partner offers (price, storage, free domain, support, best for).
- Click tracking: every /go/ click logged (partner, page it came from, date) with a report of clicks per offer per month; compare with the partner dashboard's conversions.

18.3 Rules (SEO + legal)

- All outbound affiliate links use rel=“sponsored nofollow noopener” (Google's requirement for paid/affiliate links).
- /go/ is disallowed in robots.txt and never in the sitemap.
- Visible disclosure on every page containing partner links: “Some links are affiliate links — PikaCart may earn a commission at no extra cost to you.” Plus an Affiliate Disclosure section in the footer/legal pages.
- Only recommend services actually used/tested; follow each partner programme's terms (many forbid bidding on their brand name in ads, or using the links in spam).
- Affiliate commission is income — include it in the same tax records (Section 15).

19 Articles Section

A separate reading area — reached only from the menu, never shown on the homepage

Articles are helpful guides and news (“How to track puja chanda transparently”, “Best resume format for freshers”, “How much does a school website cost?”). They exist mainly to bring free Google traffic (Section 10.6) and to build trust — but the owner wants the homepage to stay a clean shop, so articles live in their own area.

19.1 Placement rules

- Not on the homepage — no “Latest articles” block, no article cards anywhere on the home page.
- Reached only from one “Articles” item in the header menu (and the mobile menu), plus a footer link. The menu item can be renamed (e.g. “Guides”, “Blog”) or hidden from Settings.
- URL: /articles/ for the list, /articles/{keyword-slug}/ for a single article (replaces /blog/ everywhere in Section 10).
- Articles never appear in product search results or product grids; they have their own search box on the /articles/ page.

19.2 Article list page (/articles/) — list view with thumbnails

One article per row (not a grid), designed in Figma as part of the same design system as the shop (Section 14 / 19.5):

Element (per row)	Specification
Thumbnail	Left side, 16:9, 280×158 px desktop; on mobile the thumbnail goes full-width above the text. Rounded 12 px corners, lazy-loaded WebP, required alt text.
Category chip	Small pill above the title (e.g. “Website Tips”, “Study”, “Career”) — article categories are separate from product categories and fully admin-editable.
Title	H2, max 2 lines, linked to the article.
Excerpt	2–3 lines (≈ 160 characters) from the article's summary field, cut at a word boundary.
Meta line	Date · reading time (auto-calculated, e.g. “6 min read”) · author.
“View” button	Primary indigo button on the right (below the text on mobile) → opens the full article. The whole row is also clickable, with a hover lift effect.

- Page header: title “Articles”, one-line intro, search box, category filter chips (All · Website Tips · Study · Career · Kids · Committee).
- 10 articles per page, numbered pagination (/articles/page/2/), sort: newest first.
- Empty state illustration + “No articles yet” when a filter has no results.

19.3 Full article page

- 1 Breadcrumb: Home > Articles > {Category}.
- 2 H1 title, meta line (author photo + name, published/updated date, reading time), category chip.
- 3 Featured image full-width (16:9, eager-loaded as the LCP image).
- 4 Auto “Table of contents” from H2/H3 headings (collapsible on mobile, sticky on the side on desktop).

- 5 Body: comfortable reading width ($\approx$ 720 px, 18 px text, 1.7 line-height), styled headings, images with captions, quotes, tables, callout boxes (tip / warning), embedded YouTube (click-to-load so it doesn't slow the page).
- 6 "Products mentioned" box — cards of any PikaCart products/services linked in the text (Section 10.9), plus an inline CTA block the author can insert ("Need a website like this? Enquire on WhatsApp").
- 7 Author box (owner photo, short bio, link to About) — E-E-A-T trust signal (Section 10.12).
- 8 Share buttons: WhatsApp (first), Facebook, X, copy link.
- 9 "Related articles" — 3 rows in the same list style.
- 10 Previous / Next article links. No comments section at launch (avoids spam moderation); can be enabled later.

19.4 Admin: writing articles

- Admin → Articles → Add New using the standard WordPress block editor (Gutenberg) — headings, images, tables, lists without code.
- Fields: title, slug, summary/excerpt, featured image (required, with alt), article category, tags, author, status (draft / scheduled / published).
- The same SEO panel and publish gate as products (Section 10.7): SEO title, description, focus keyword, $\geq$ 900 words guide, internal-link suggestions.
- Schedule posts for future dates; "Updated on" date shown automatically when an article is edited significantly.

19.5 Design — fully from the Figma design system

- Articles list, article page, filters, pagination, empty state and mobile versions are designed as Figma frames first (desktop 1440 px, tablet 768 px, mobile 375 px), using the same colour tokens, Poppins type scale, spacing (8 px grid), radius, shadows and button components as the shop.
- Build is pixel-matched to the Figma frames; all text sizes/colours come from the shared CSS design tokens so shop and articles always look like one product.
- Light theme first; dark-mode tokens defined in Figma for later.

19.6 SEO specifics

- BlogPosting/Article schema + BreadcrumbList on every article; CollectionPage + ItemList on /articles/.
- Articles included in the XML sitemap; article category pages noindex until they hold $\geq$ 5 articles.
- Because articles are not on the homepage, the header "Articles" link, footer link, related-articles block and links from product/service pages carry their internal linking — every new article must be linked from at least one product or service page (orphan report, Section 10.9).

20 Launch Checklist

Task	Owner	Status
Single Seller Mode ON, default WhatsApp number set	Site owner	☐
Contact Us page written and published	Site owner	☐
Delivery / Service Policy page written and published	Site owner	☐
15–20 starter digital products published (Section 8.1), each with SEO fields complete (Section 10.3)	Site owner	☐
4–6 service listings published (Section 8.2) with portfolio screenshots	Site owner	☐
Razorpay: activation form submitted, test order + refund verified	Site owner	☐
Google Search Console verified, sitemap submitted	Site owner	☐
SMTP email sending verified (order confirmations, verification emails)	Site owner	☐
GST / government-employee question resolved with a professional	Site owner + CA/lawyer	☐
Every service has packages, FAQ (3+), portfolio items and What's-included list	Site owner	☐
SEO acceptance tests in Section 10.14 all pass	Developer	☐
Google Business Profile created (service-area business)	Site owner	☐
Affiliate programmes joined, /go/ links + disclosure live	Site owner	☐
Articles menu item live, 3+ articles published (not on homepage)	Site owner	☐
Launch coupon created (e.g. LAUNCH20) + announcement bar	Site owner	☐
Go live with real Razorpay keys	Site owner	☐

End of specification. Build proceeds section by section against this document; any change during the build gets written back in here first, then implemented — so this stays the single source of truth.